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Muslims: Their Religious Beliefs and Practices

Liyakatali Takim

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Book Profile

Andrew Rippin, *Muslims: Their Religious Beliefs and Practices*. London: Routledge, 2001. 346 pages. Second edition. ISBN 0-415-21782-2.

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The book is a revised edition of the author's first work that was published in two volumes. Designed as a textbook for students in Islam the book consists of seventeen chapters covering different topics related to the teaching of Islam in a department of religious studies. The period covered includes the emergence of Islam in seventh century Arabia, the formation and consolidation of Islamic identity in the classical period of Islam extending to the modern vision and re-vision of Islam. The intent of the author is to examine the beliefs and practices of Muslims in their social, cultural and historical settings and the integration of these diverse factors in the formation of the Islamic tradition. His discussion shows why Islam should not be regarded as a monolithic entity. The author also attempts to redress what he claims to be a lack of critical analysis that is apparent in many introductory textbooks on Islam (pg 1). Thus he discusses not only the crystallization of Muslim beliefs and practices but also, by examining the textual sources, the literary formation of Islam in its classical heritage ' a remnant of the orientalist approach to the study of Islamic civilization.

Liyakatali Takim is a Assistant Professor at the University of Denver. He has translated numerous books and is the author of various articles in Islamic studies.. His latest article titled 'From Bid'a to Sunna: The Case of the Wilaya of 'Ali b. Abu Talib in the Shi'i adhan' was published in the *Journal of The American Oriental Study* in June 2000. He is currently writing on charismatic authority and the emergence of the jurist and holy man in Islam. Fluent in seven languages, Professor Takim has taught at various institutions including at the University of Toronto and the University of Miami.

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